INCH-POUND

A-A-20000B
March 14, 1995
SUPERSEDING
A-A-20000A
December 30, 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CEREAL, PREPARED, READY-TO-EAT

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this commercial item description by all federal agencies.

1. SCOPE.

1.1 This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers prepared, ready-to-eat cereals, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal Government.

2. CLASSIFICATION.

2.1 The prepared, ready-to-eat cereal shall conform to the types, classes, and styles in the following list which shall be specified, in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Types, classes, and styles.

Type I - Wheat products.

Class 1 - Shredded whole wheat

Style A - Large shredded wheat biscuits
Style B - Small shredded wheat biscuits
Style C - Loose shredded wheat

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Head, Food Quality Assurance Staff, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2506, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.

FSC 8920

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:31Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Style D - Medium shredded wheat biscuits
Style E - Small shredded wheat biscuits, coated
Style F - Medium shredded wheat biscuits, coated
Style G - Small shredded wheat biscuits, fruit-filled

Class 2 - Pressed-flake whole-wheat biscuits
Class 3 - Wheat flakes
Class 4 - Malted wheat flakes
Class 5 - Bran flakes (25 to 40 percent)
Class 6 - Bran flakes (25 to 40 percent) and raisins
Class 7 - Wheat bran (prepared)
Class 8 - Puffed wheat (gun-puffed)
Class 9 - Puffed wheat (gun-puffed), coated
Class 10 - Malted cereal granules
Class 11 - Malted cereal granules and raisins
Class 12 - Wheat bran biscuits
Class 13 - Wheat cereal (expanded/extruded), coated
Class 14 - Wheat flakes, dried fruit and nuts
Class 15 - Wheat flakes with raisins
Class 16 - Bran flakes with fruit
Class 17 - Wheat bran with fruit and nuts
Class 18 - Other

Type II - Corn products.

Class 1 - Corn flakes
Class 2 - Corn flakes, coated
Class 3 - Corn cereal (gun-puffed)
Class 4 - Corn cereal (gun-puffed), coated, with or without fruit or cinnamon or other flavorings, with or without dried fruit
Class 5 - Shredded corn, small biscuits (oven-puffed)
Class 6 - Corn cereal (oven-puffed)
Class 7 - Corn cereal with oats, small biscuits (oven-puffed), coated or uncoated
Class 8 - Corn cereal (expanded/extruded)
Class 9 - Corn cereal (expanded/extruded), coated
Class 10 - Corn cereal with oats, small bisquits (oven-puffed)
Class 11 - Other

Type III - Rice products.

Class 1 - Puffed rice (gun-puffed)
Class 2 - Rice cereal (oven-puffed)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:31Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Class 3 - Rice cereal (oven-puffed), coated, with or without cocoa
Class 4 - Rice flakes
Class 5 - Rice flakes or granules, protein enriched

Style A - High rice component
Style B - Low rice component

Class 6 - Shredded rice, small biscuits (oven-puffed)
Class 7 - Puffed rice (gun-puffed), coated
Class 8 - Rice flakes with rye and raisins
Class 9 - Rice cereal (expanded/extruded)
Class 10 - Other

Type IV - Oat products.

Class 1 - Oat cereal (oven- or gun-puffed)
Class 2 - Oat cereal (oven- or gun-puffed), coated
Class 3 - Oat cereal (other than oven- or gun-puffed)

Style A - Biscuits
Style B - Flakes or granules

Class 4 - Oat flakes
Class 5 - Oat cereal (expanded/extruded), coated
Class 6 - Granola cereal (agglomerate of rolled oats with optional ingredients including coconut, brown sugar, honey, nuts, sesame seeds, etc.)
Class 7 - Granola cereal and dried fruit (agglomerate of rolled oats with optional ingredients including coconut, brown sugar, honey, nuts, sesame seeds, etc.)
Class 8 - Oat cereal with soy and corn flours, small biscuits, oven puffed, cooked
Class 9 - Oatmeal flakes with fruit and nuts
Class 10 - Oat bran flakes
Class 11 - Oat bran flakes with raisins
Class 12 - Oat bran flakes with fruit
Class 13 - Oat bran flakes with fruit and nuts
Class 14 - Other

Type V - Rye products.

Class 1 - Rye flakes
Class 2 - Other

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T08:31Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Type VI - Barley products.

Class 1 - Barley flakes
Class 2 - Other

Type VII - Combination grain products. Product may be a combination of two or more grains.

Class 1 - Wheat and barley flakes
Class 2 - Whole wheat and buckwheat flakes
Class 3 - Puffed oat and wheat
Class 4 - Puffed corn and oat
Class 5 - Oat and soy squares or biscuits
Class 6 - Cinnamon oat and soy squares or biscuits
Class 7 - Wheat bran and corn squares or biscuits
Class 8 - Corn, oat, wheat, and rice flakes
Class 9 - Whole wheat, corn, rice, and oat flakes
Class 10 - Whole wheat, corn, rice, and oat flakes with fruit and nuts
Class 11 - Rice and wheat flakes
Class 12 - Corn bran and oat
Class 13 - Rice and corn flakes with raisins and almonds
Class 14 - Barley, oat, wheat, corn, and rice cereal with fruit and nuts
Class 15 - Puffed corn, wheat, and oat
Class 16 - Wheat bran and oat bran nuggets
Class 17 - Corn and rice biscuits
Class 18 - Rice and rye flakes with fruit
Class 19 - Barley, oat, wheat, corn, and rice cereal
Class 20 - Corn and oat biscuit, presweetened
Class 21 - Granola cereal, low fat (agglomerate of whole grain oats and whole grain wheat with optional ingredients including brown sugar, raisins, rice, and almonds)
Class 22 - Other

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Taste and odor: The prepared, ready-to-eat cereal shall be of good characteristic taste and odor and shall be free from rancid, musty, sour, and other undesirable tastes and odors.

3.2 Foreign material: There shall be no evidence of foreign material in the prepared, ready-to-eat cereal.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:31Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3 Age requirement: Unless otherwise specified, the prepared, ready-to-eat cereal shall be processed and packaged not more than 60 days prior to shipment.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

4.1 The delivered prepared, ready-to-eat cereal shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the prepared, ready-to-eat cereal within the commercial marketplace. Delivered prepared, ready-to-eat cereal shall comply with all applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Contractor's certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the prepared, ready-to-eat cereal offered meets the salient characteristics of this CID, and the prepared, ready-to-eat cereal conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and is the same prepared, ready-to-eat cereal offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

5.2 Quality assurance. When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the Federal Grain Inspection Service (FGIS) of the U.S. Department of Agriculture will determine the quality assurance of the prepared, ready-to-eat cereal according to FGIS procedures. The prepared, ready-to-eat cereal shall be examined and/or analyzed in accordance with applicable provisions in the CID, and when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers currently in effect on the date of the solicitation.

6. PACKAGING.

6.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking shall be as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

7. NOTES.

7.1 Purchasers shall specify:

- Product types, classes, and styles, as appropriate.
- Labeling requirements, if different from normal commercial practice.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:31Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

7.2 Sources of documents.

7.2.1 Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. This three-volume set may be purchased from: **Superintendent of Documents, ATTN: New Orders, P.O. Box 371954, Pittsburgh, PA 15250-7954**. Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 512-1800.

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from: **Chairperson, Condition of Container Committee, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2506, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456**.

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from: **General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service Bureau, Specifications Section, Suite 8100, 470 L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407**.

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to: **Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4, Section D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094**.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity

Army - GL

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 35

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DLA - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - NIH, IHS
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - FV

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:31Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.